

Stallman, who had considered software merely as a source of information to be shared between people, was worried that the measures put up by vendors would make the life of users difficult, by depriving them of the freedom of usage.

1.3.2 GNU, GPL and Free Software Foundation

Stallman's response to PS was the GNU (a recursive abbreviation for "GNU's Not UNIX"). It was intended to be a free operating system, which came with the source code. Since most programmers were comfortable with Unix, GNU set out to be a Unix clone. Stallman received the collaboration of other volunteer programmers for the project. That was in 1983. While Stallman referred to GNU as a "free" OS intending it to mean "freedom of choice (use, modify and distribute)" to the user, people mistook "free" to be "free of cost." This confusion proved disastrous to the movement, leading to the branching out of the OSI.

The GPL or General Public License was a licensing scheme devised by Stallman to ensure that programs released under that license remained free perpetually. Copyrighted software was the property of the copyright holder. If a copyright expired, the software would be placed in the public domain for anyone to use. Here the program can be included in other proprietary software and be lost to the public. A software licensed under the GPL (also called "copyleft") remained free because not only was the software free, but also every program that utilised a GPL software in turn was automatically copylefted.

The Free Software Foundation (FSF) was created in 1984 to ensure a source of funding for the GNU project. The Indian Affiliate of FSF, FSF India, was set up in Kerala in 2001 and inaugurated by Stallman.

1.3.3 Linus Torvalds

Torvalds was a computer science student at the University of Helsinki when he came across the Minix operating system. Minix was open source in that the 12,000 lines of code were given in a